

THE EVOLUTION OF MONEY

MODULE 1.2 FIELD LAB

Problem solved. Dependency added. Risk transformed.

COGNIZEN CONSULTING

Follow the coordination problem

For each stage, name the problem reduced and the new dependency introduced. Avoid claiming that one form simply replaced all earlier forms.

SYSTEM	PROBLEM REDUCED	DEPENDENCY ADDED	WHAT CAN FAIL?
Obligation / credit			
Commodity money			
Standardised coin			
Representative note			
Bank deposit			
Fiat currency			
Cryptocurrency			

Which stages coexist in your life today?

Locate the trust boundary

A payment object tells only part of the story. Trace the claim, the record keeper and the rule-changing authority.

FORM	WHAT DOES THE HOLDER HAVE?	WHO KEEPS THE RECORD?	WHO CAN CHANGE THE RULES?
Metal coin			
Redeemable note			
Commercial-bank deposit			
Central-bank money			
Public-chain asset			

The most important difference I found

Compare the trade, not the slogan

Choose two payment systems for one real situation. Score only after you define the user's need.

Situation and user

DIMENSION	SYSTEM A	SYSTEM B	EVIDENCE / LIMIT
Access			
Settlement speed			
Cost predictability			
Reversibility			
Privacy			
Resilience			
Governance clarity			

My bounded conclusion

Explain change without mythology

Use complete sentences. A strong answer names both the improvement and its dependency.

Barter is an incomplete origin story because...

Coinage improved exchange, but introduced...

Fiat money is not commodity-backed, yet depends on...

Cryptocurrency's distinctive change is...

A new monetary form does not guarantee replacement because...

KEEP THIS

Monetary progress is a sequence of changing trust boundaries, not a march toward risk-free money.